Training Evidence: Time Restriction

Installation and user guide for the Moodle plugin

Plugin · availability_eftime

Version 1.4.4 · Works with Moodle 5.1 to 5.3

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PART 1

Quick start

The essentials for setting up a time restriction in a few minutes.

What it is and what it is for

It adds a **"Restrict access" condition** to Moodle that **locks an activity or a section** until the student has spent a **minimum active time**, as measured by `local_efreport`, either **in the course** or **in a specific activity**.

- No access to a **certificate** until the student has spent *X* time **in the course**.
- No access to a **quiz** until the student has spent *X* time **in an activity** (for example, the topic video).
- Lock a **section** until the student has spent *X* time **in the course and** *X* in an activity.
- It **combines** with the other restrictions (completion, date, grade and so on) using Moodle's **AND / OR** sets.

Minimum requirements

- **Moodle 5.1, 5.2 or 5.3**, with administrator rights to install plugins.
- **Requires** `local_efreport` **2.7.0 or later** (it measures the time). Moodle **blocks the installation** if it is missing or is an earlier version.
- The course must be **tracking time** with the Training Evidence Report (otherwise the plugin warns you and students stay locked out).

Install in 3 steps

1. Go to **Site administration → Plugins → Install plugins** and upload the file `availability_eftime_vX.zip`.
2. Click **Install plugin from the ZIP file** and, on the database upgrade screen, **Continue**.
3. Done: the **"Active time"** condition is now available under "Restrict access".

Set up the restriction in 4 steps

1. Edit an **activity or section** → **"Restrict access"** section → **"Add restriction..."**.
2. Choose **"Active time"** from the list.

3. Select **where time is measured** (in the whole course or in an activity) and enter the **hours and minutes**.
4. **Save**. If you wish, combine it with other restrictions using AND / OR.

3 key tips to get started

RECOMMENDED

Make sure the course is **tracking time** with the Training Evidence Report before you add the restriction. If it is not, the editor warns you and students **will not be able to get in**.

TIP

Use the **eye icon** in "Restrict access" to decide whether the locked activity is **shown greyed out with the reason** (recommended) or **hidden entirely**.

WATCH OUT

The time is re-evaluated **when the page is reloaded**. When a student reaches the threshold while working, they will need to **refresh** the page for the activity to unlock (this is how "Restrict access" works in Moodle).

PART 2

Full guide

Every detail on use, settings and special cases.

1 What the plugin does in detail

It is an **availability condition** (`availability_*`) that plugs into Moodle's native **"Restrict access"** system. When a student opens the course page, Moodle evaluates the condition and compares the student's **accumulated active time** with the threshold you have set:

- **Time in the course** = the time **measured by the clock** of the Training Evidence Report for that student. It does not include estimated time from before the clock was enabled, nor does it apply the group period that the report itself can apply: it may be slightly lower than the report total, never higher (the gate only opens with genuinely measured time).
- **Time in an activity** = the time spent on the specific activity you choose.
- It counts **all accumulated time**, including time spent before the restriction was added.

> **ONE CONDITION, ONE TARGET**
>
> Each condition measures **one** target (the course **or** one activity) plus its threshold. To require several things at once, **add the condition several times** and combine them with Moodle's AND / OR. This is the most flexible approach: course plus one activity, several activities, with AND or with OR.

2 Requirements and the efreport dependency

- **Moodle 5.1 to 5.3** (`supported = [501, 503]`).
- **Mandatory dependency:** `local_efreport` **2.7.0 or later**. This plugin reads the time through efreport's **public API** (`\local_efreport\local\timeapi`), without touching its tables. If efreport is missing or too old, **Moodle will not let you install** and says so in the plugins check.
- **Privacy:** the plugin **stores no personal data** (null provider); it only reads what efreport already records.

> **UNINSTALLING (ORDER)**
>
> Because this plugin **requires efreport**, Moodle **will not let you uninstall efreport** while this Time Restriction is installed (the plugin list shows "*Required by: availability_eftime*"). If you want to remove efreport, **uninstall this plugin first**.

3 Installation (web, manual and CLI)

Method 1 — Web interface (recommended)

1. **Site administration → Plugins → Install plugins**.
2. Drag the ZIP file in and click **Install plugin from the ZIP file**.
3. Confirm and **upgrade the database** when prompted.

Method 2 — Manual file copy

1. Unzip the file and copy the `eftime` folder into `availability/condition/` (in Moodle 5.x, `public/availability/condition/`).
2. Go to **Site administration → Notifications** and follow the wizard.

Method 3 — Command line

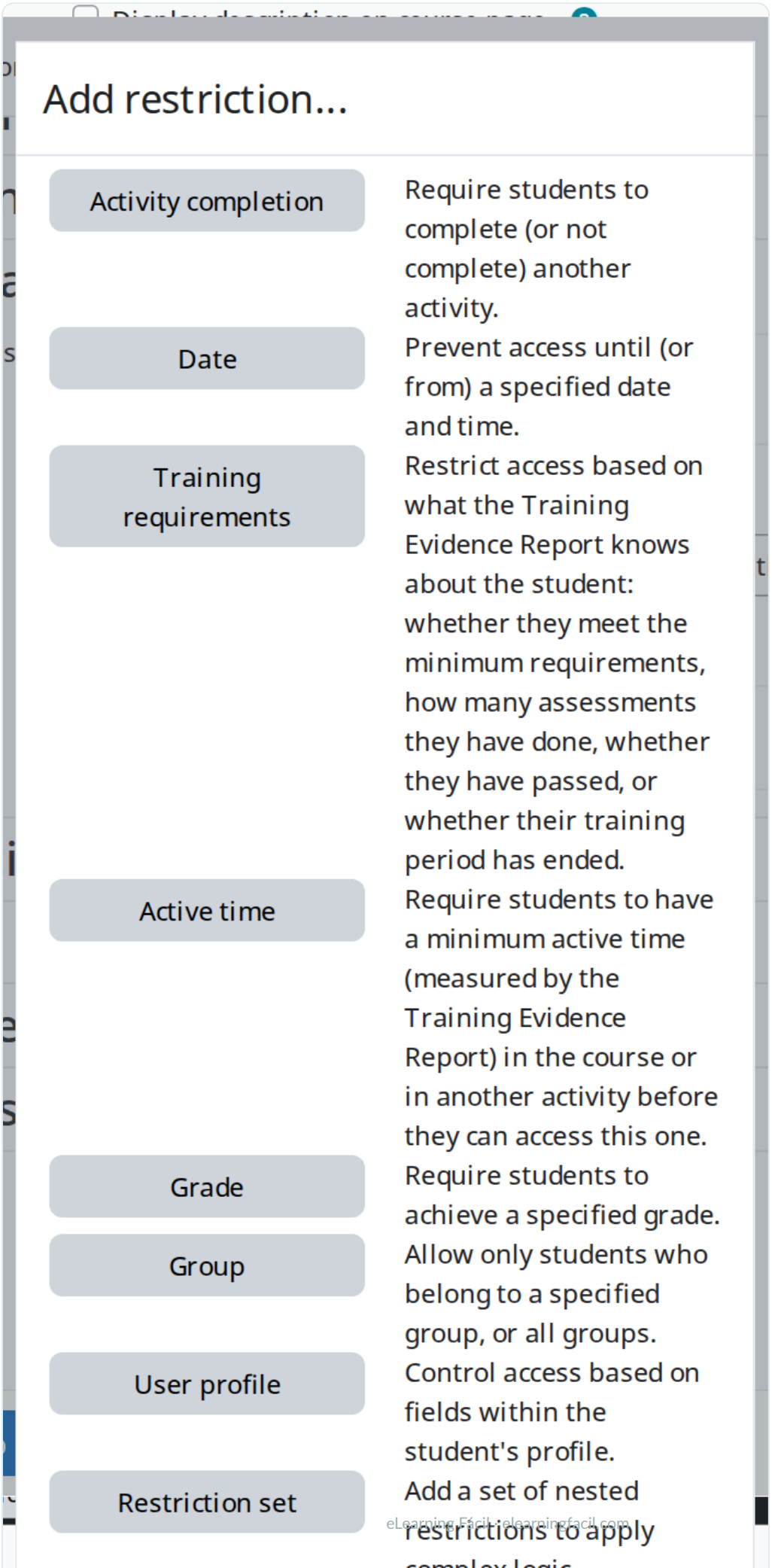
Copy the folder and run:

```
php admin/cli/upgrade.php
```

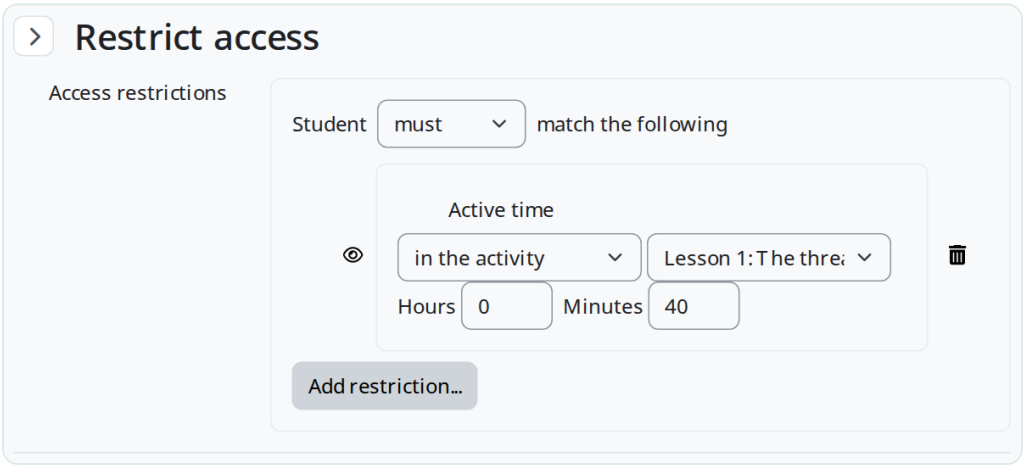
> **TIP**
>
> After installing, run `php admin/cli/purge_caches.php` so that the condition appears in the "Add restriction..." dialogue.

4 Adding the condition (course or activity)

1. Edit the activity or section → expand **"Restrict access"**.
2. Click **"Add restriction..."** and choose **"Active time"**.
3. In the **"Where time is measured"** drop-down, choose **"in the whole course"** or **"in the activity"**. If you choose the activity, the **"Activity"** drop-down offers **"Previous activity"** new (the one immediately before this item in the course, ideal for sequential content: if you reorder the course, it adapts on its own; labels do not count as activities, and subsections are walked through in the same order the student follows) or a **specific activity**. If that specific activity is deleted, the restriction stays closed until you edit it.
4. Enter the time in **Hours** and **Minutes** (for example, 0 h 30 min).


Add restriction...
Activity completion
Require students to complete (or not complete) another activity.
Date
Prevent access until (or from) a specified date and time.
Training requirements
Restrict access based on what the Training Evidence Report knows about the student: whether they meet the minimum requirements, how many assessments they have done, whether they have passed, or whether their training period has ended.
Active time
Require students to have a minimum active time (measured by the Training Evidence Report) in the course or in another activity before they can access this one.
Grade
Require students to achieve a specified grade.
Group
Allow only students who belong to a specified group, or all groups.
User profile
Control access based on fields within the student's profile.
Restriction set
Add a set of nested restrictions to apply

When adding the restriction, choose "Active time".



Two conditions combined: time **in the whole course** and time **in the previous activity** (sequential content).

IF THE COURSE IS NOT TRACKING TIME

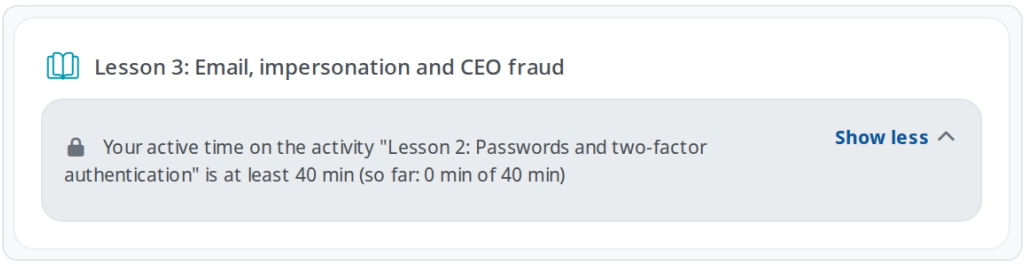
The editor warns you: *"Warning: time is not being tracked in this course (the Training Evidence Report is not enabled here). Unless you enable time tracking, students will not be able to access this activity."* It **lets you save** (in case you enable efreport later), but while the course is not tracking time the activity stays **locked** (fail-closed, the safer choice for audits).

5 Combining it with other restrictions

Because it is a native condition, it combines with the others through Moodle's **AND / OR** sets. A real example: lock a quiz until the student has **completed Topic 1**, **a given date** has passed, they have **30 min in the course and 10 min on the topic video**. You add several restrictions and Moodle applies them together.

6 What the student sees (message and progress)

With the eye icon set to "shown", the student sees the activity greyed out with the reason. The plugin generates the text:



The student sees the padlock, the requirement and how far they have got ("at least 40 min (so far: 0 min of 40 min)").

The **progress** ("so far: 12 min of 30 min") is **optional**: the administrator controls it site-wide and, if allowed, each course can set it too (see §7). With progress turned off, the student sees only the requirement: *"Your active time in this course is at least 30 min"*.

7 Settings (site-wide and per course)

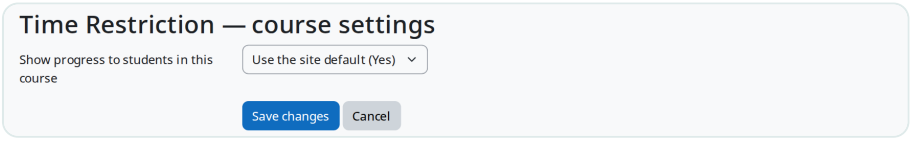
Site-wide settings (administrator)

In **Site administration → Plugins → Availability restrictions → "Training Evidence: Time Restriction"**:

Setting	What it does	Default
Show progress to students	Shows "so far: X of Y" alongside the requirement.	Enabled
Allow "Show progress to students" to be set per course	Lets each course override the setting above.	Disabled

Per-course setting (if the administrator allows it)

When the administrator enables **Allow "Show progress to students" to be set per course**, a **"Time Restriction"** entry appears in the course's **Training Management** menu (or, if the Training Evidence Report is not installed, under Course administration), with the option **Show progress to students in this course**: *Use the site default / Yes, show progress / No, do not show progress*. Useful in courses where seeing the progress could be confusing.



The per-course settings page (Training Management → "Time Restriction").

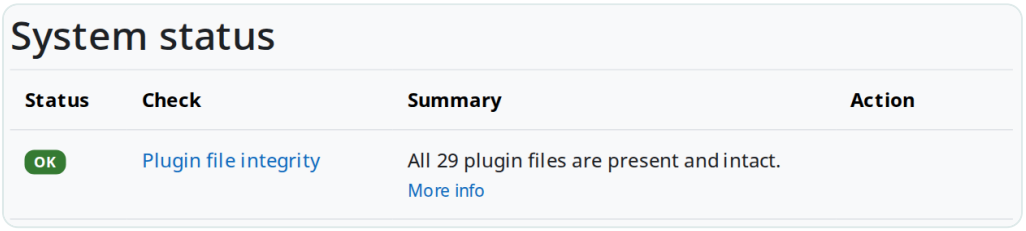
8 Special cases and good practice

- **Label in "Restrict access":** the condition is called **"Active time"** (the plugin's name is "Training Evidence: Time Restriction").
- **Teachers and managers** with the *ignore availability restrictions* capability always see the activity; test the lock with a **student account**.
- **Backup and restore:** the restriction **travels with each activity** and the chosen activity is **remapped** automatically ("Previous activity" is relative and needs no remapping). The only exception: the per-course "show progress" setting does not travel (Moodle offers no such hook to availability plugins); after restoring on another site, turn it back on if you were using it. One click.
- **When the training has to be proven (Spain's FUNDAE® training scheme, formación bonificada, among others):** combine this restriction with the Training Evidence Report to ensure a **minimum active time** before a piece of content counts as passed or a certificate is issued.

9 Installation integrity check new

Every zip ships with an **integrity manifest**. After installing or updating, open **Site administration → Reports → System status**: the "Plugin file integrity" row should read **OK**. If your hosting lost or emptied a file during

installation (it happens on some shared hosts), you will see **Error with the exact list**: reinstall the plugin from its zip and purge the caches.



One glance confirms the whole installation, with no need to check folders by hand.

10 Other eLearning Fácil plugins

It is part of the **eLearning Fácil** family of training evidence plugins, the Training Evidence Pack:

local_efreport

Training Evidence: Time, Activity & Evaluation Report. Measures each student's real active time. **It is the foundation** of this plugin (required).

local_efcomms

Training Evidence: Communications Report. Audits forums and messaging between students and tutors to evidence tutor support.

MORE INFORMATION

There is also `block_eflinks` (Training Evidence: Report Links, quick access to every report from inside the course). Find out more at **elearningfacil.com**.

11 Frequently asked questions

Symptom	Cause / fix
"Active time" does not appear when adding a restriction	`local_efreport` 2.7.0 or later is missing, or you did not purge the caches after installing.
The student cannot get in despite having plenty of time	Is the course tracking time with the Training Evidence Report? If it is not, the activity stays locked.
The student cannot see their progress	Progress is turned off (site-wide or for the course). Turn it on in the settings.
The student reached the time but is still locked out	They need to **reload** the page; the condition is re-evaluated on page load.
I (a teacher) can see the activity despite the restriction	That is correct: you have the capability to ignore availability restrictions. Test with a student account.
I cannot see "Time Restriction" in the course menu	The administrator needs to enable **Allow "Show progress to students" to be set per course** in the plugin settings (it is disabled by default on purpose).
"Plugin file integrity" shows Error	The hosting damaged files during installation: reinstall the plugin from its zip and purge the caches.

12 Support

ELEARNING FÁCIL

Questions, or need it adapted to your platform? Write to us at **elearningfacil.com**. We will be glad to help you get your training evidence in order.

Guide for the `availability_eftime` plugin · version 1.4.4 · © 2026 eLearning Fácil. Works with Moodle 5.1 to 5.3. Requires `local_efreport` 2.7.0 or later.

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